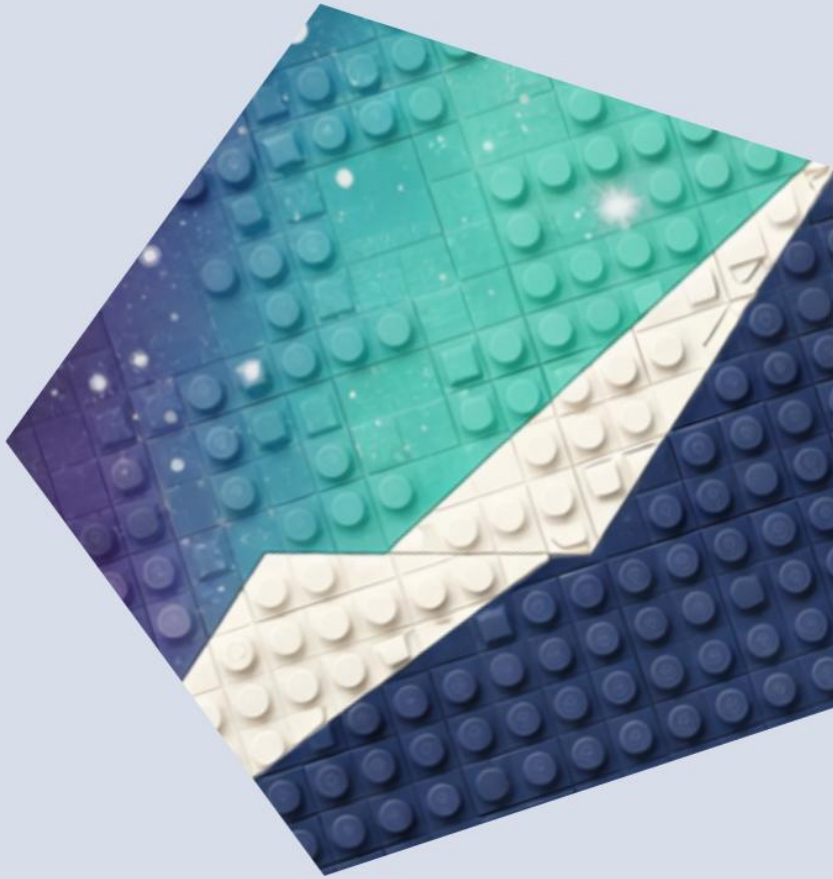




nordic summit

Billund | 21st-22nd September 2026

Forgotten features of Dataverse

Nick Doelman · Microsoft MVP & MCT · ReadyBMS

Nordic Summit 2026 · Billund · Monday 21 September



Platform



L200

ABOUT YOUR SPEAKER

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Microsoft MVP (8x) | Solution Architect | AI Explorer | Content Creator | Trainer | Advisor



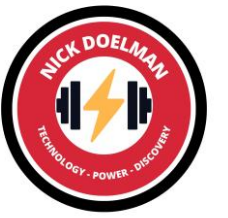
Microsoft MVP (8x)



Power Platform BOOST



Canada Powerlifting



readyxrm.blog · ReadyBMS · Ottawa

nickdoelman.com

Blog, sessions, podcast, and everything I publish. All of it lives there.

Microsoft Dataverse – what's in the box?



TWENTY MINUTES

What you'll take away

Six things already in your environment, one new piece, and why the old ones matter again.

Email, already wired in

Server-side sync and the Outlook app. No flow runs, no service account.

Columns that self-fill

Field mappings, and calculated columns that reach across a lookup.

The odd ones

Polymorphic lookups, multi-currency, and a diagnostics page most people never see.

All of it is on the shelf. None of it costs extra.

The Dataverse MCP server

One endpoint, and your agent has hands on tables, data and metadata.

Dataverse Skills

Microsoft's eight skills, so the agent works the way you would.

The one nobody expects

A twenty-year-old reporting engine, back in play.

Nothing here needs a new license. It is all in the environment you already run.

1

Bricks at the bottom of the box

Features that shipped years ago and never got picked up.

FORGOTTEN FEATURE

Email is already wired into Dataverse

In the box since CRM 2013. The flow runs you are paying for are optional.

Server-side sync

Exchange Online connects to your environment directly. Send and receive from the app.

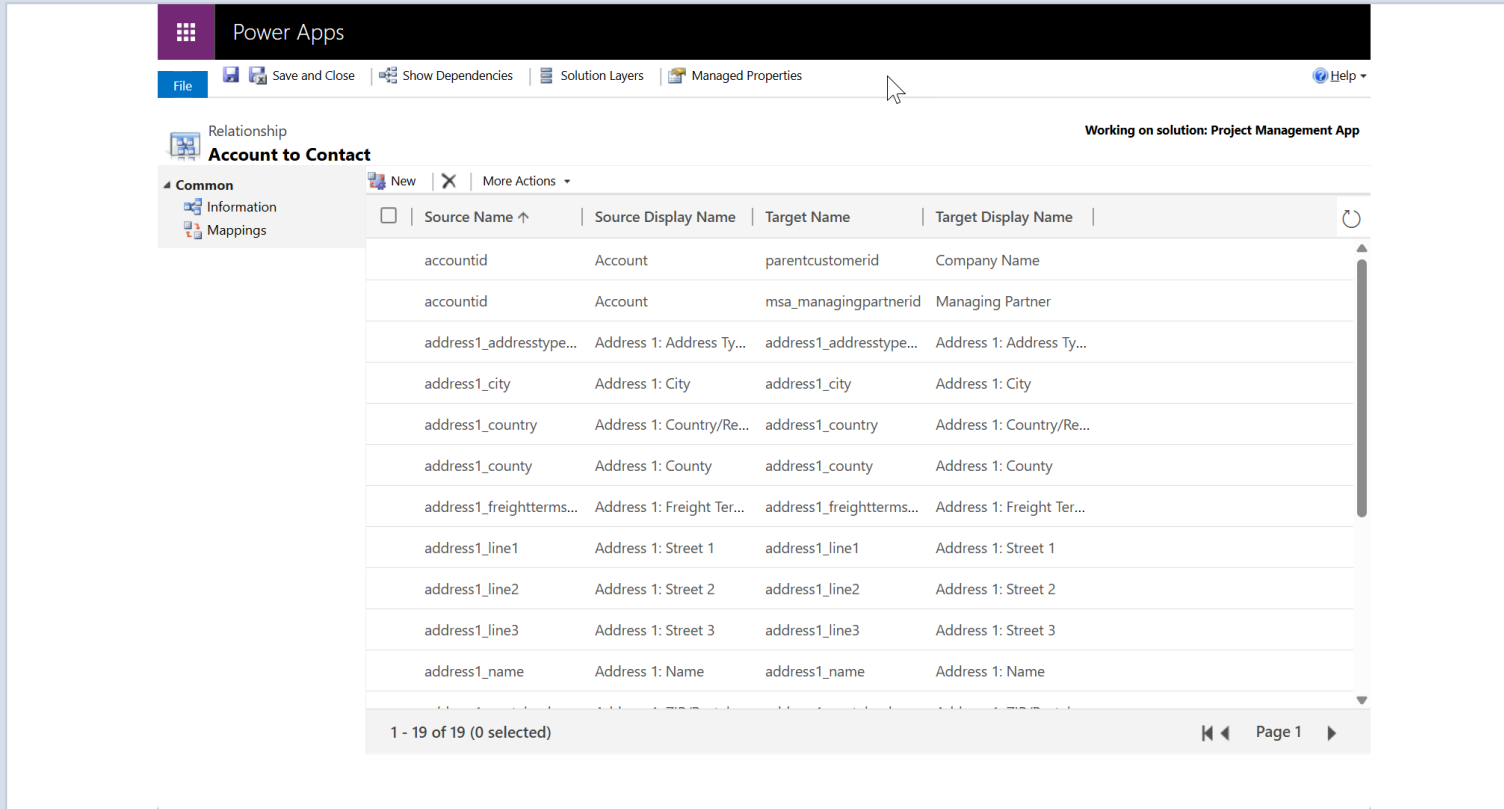
The Outlook app

Track emails to records and link contacts. Any Power Apps license covers it.

Why it got forgotten

Microsoft still calls it the Dynamics 365 App for Outlook. You do not need that license.

Field mappings fill the form for you



The screenshot shows the Power Apps interface for a relationship named 'Account to Contact'. A table lists field mappings from source fields to target fields. The table has columns: Source Name, Source Display Name, Target Name, and Target Display Name. The mappings include accountid to parentcustomerid, address1 fields to address1 fields, and address1_name to address1_name. The table is part of a 'Relationship' view, and the solution being worked on is 'Project Management App'.

Source Name	Source Display Name	Target Name	Target Display Name
accountid	Account	parentcustomerid	Company Name
accountid	Account	msa_managingpartnerid	Managing Partner
address1_addresstype...	Address 1: Address Ty...	address1_addresstype...	Address 1: Address Ty...
address1_city	Address 1: City	address1_city	Address 1: City
address1_country	Address 1: Country/Re...	address1_country	Address 1: Country/Re...
address1_county	Address 1: County	address1_county	Address 1: County
address1_freightterms...	Address 1: Freight Ter...	address1_freightterms...	Address 1: Freight Ter...
address1_line1	Address 1: Street 1	address1_line1	Address 1: Street 1
address1_line2	Address 1: Street 2	address1_line2	Address 1: Street 2
address1_line3	Address 1: Street 3	address1_line3	Address 1: Street 3
address1_name	Address 1: Name	address1_name	Address 1: Name

Parent updates do not cascade. Say "field mappings" to anyone who mocks the classic interface.

What it does

Create a contact from an account and the address fields arrive filled in.

Why it got forgotten

The UI only lives in the classic interface. The modern table designer pretends it is not there.

The gotchas

Same field type, same or smaller size, and it fires on create only.

Calculated columns reach across a lookup

SAVE SAVE AND CLOSE ?

CALCULATED FIELD

Set Supplier City

IF...THEN

CONDITION (OPTIONAL)

+ Add condition

ACTION

Set Supplier City (single line of text)

= cr6aa_supplier.

accountnumber (single line of text) Account Number

address1_city (single line of text) Address 1: City

address1_country (single line of text) address1_country Address 1: Country/Region

address1_county (single line of text) Address 1: County

<https://readyxrm.blog>

Locate supplier lookup column

Press "."

Select related column

Form

Widget	Widget A
Description	This is widget A
Supplier	ACME Ltd
Supplier City	Redmond

Widget table

Widget	Description	Supplier ID	Supplier City (calculated field)
Widget A	This is widget A	1234	1234.Redmond
Widget B	This is widget B	3456	3456.Dallas
Widget C	This is widget C	3456	3456.Dallas

Supplier table

Supplier key ID	Supplier Name	Supplier City
1234	ACME Ltd	Redmond
3456	Contoso	Dallas

<https://readyxrm.blog>

Not just maths

Press the dot after a lookup and drill into the related table.

Why Power Pages cares

Related columns on a list break sorting and search on the portal.

Sortable and searchable

Read-only, but it lands on a form or a list like any other column.

Six more, quickly

One line each. Take a photo of this slide and go looking afterwards.

Polymorphic lookups

One column pointing at several tables. The Customer lookup does it. No maker UI, so use the SDK or XrmToolBox.

Multi-currency

Every currency column quietly creates a base value, an exchange rate and a currency lookup. Rates are yours to update.

The diagnostics page

/tools/diagnostics/diag.aspx on your org URL. Latency, bandwidth, payload size. Numbers instead of feelings.

Run the diagnostics page on a schedule and keep the results. When users say the app is slow, you will have a baseline.

Excel and Word

Export to Excel, edit, publish back. Word templates generate documents straight off a record.

SharePoint documents

Document storage on a record without writing anything. Turn it on in the admin centre.

Duplicate detection

Rules and jobs that have been in the product since CRM 3.0, and still work.

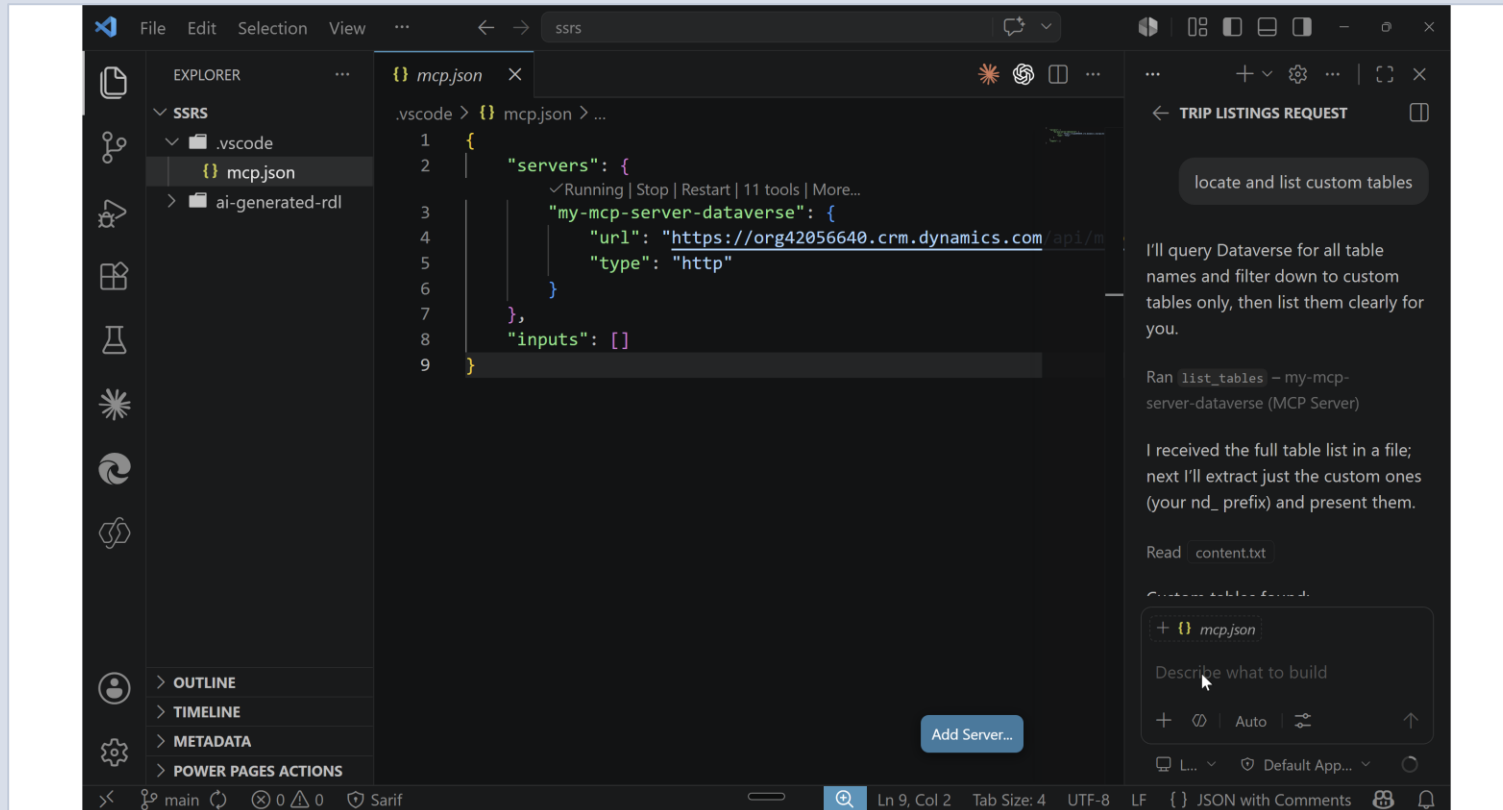
None of these need code. Most of them need about ten minutes.

2

A new piece in the box

Late 2025 added one part that changes what the old ones are worth.

The Dataverse MCP server



The endpoint is <https://<org>.crm.dynamics.com/api/mcp>. A standard plug, not a Microsoft-only connector.

One endpoint

Any compliant client works: Copilot Studio, Visual Studio Code, Claude, Cursor.

What the agent gets

list_tables, describe_table, read_query, search, fetch. Then create, update and delete.

Admin gated

Enabled per environment, clients allow-listed. Treat it like a service principal.

Dataverse Skills, MCP with instructions

github.com/microsoft/Dataverse-skills. One install, eight skills, no build steps.

dv-overview and dv-connect

Routes the request to the right skill, then handles first-time setup and registers the MCP server for you.

dv-query and dv-data

Read, filter and aggregate. Then create, update, delete, and bulk import from CSV or generated data.

dv-metadata

Tables, columns, relationships, forms and views. Schema work described in plain English.

dv-connect is the one that matters on day one. It bootstraps everything else.

dv-solution

Solution lifecycle across environments.

dv-admin

Environment settings, audit, bulk delete, recycle bin.

dv-security

Roles, users and business units.

Same skills install into GitHub Copilot, Claude Code and Codex. Use the harness you already pay for.

3

The brick under the sofa

One more forgotten feature. Any guesses?

SQL Server Reporting Services

File

Edit Filter

2 of 2 100% Find | Next

Invoice **MAGNETISM®**

To: **Frosty's Ice Cream Store**
113 Icy Lane
New Scoopington 1101
Las Sprinkles

Invoice #: INV-01001-V2H8R0
Due Date: 2/10/2015

Description	Price	Quantity	Amount
Banana	\$89.00	1.00	\$89.00
Blueberry	\$70.00	1.00	\$70.00
Choc Chip	\$122.00	1.00	\$122.00
		Tax	\$42.15
Total			\$323.15

How many invoices, quotes and work orders still need to print? Rather a lot.

Born with CRM 3.0

RDL files, FetchXML datasets, parameters, pixel-perfect print. Free with your environment.

Why it got forgotten

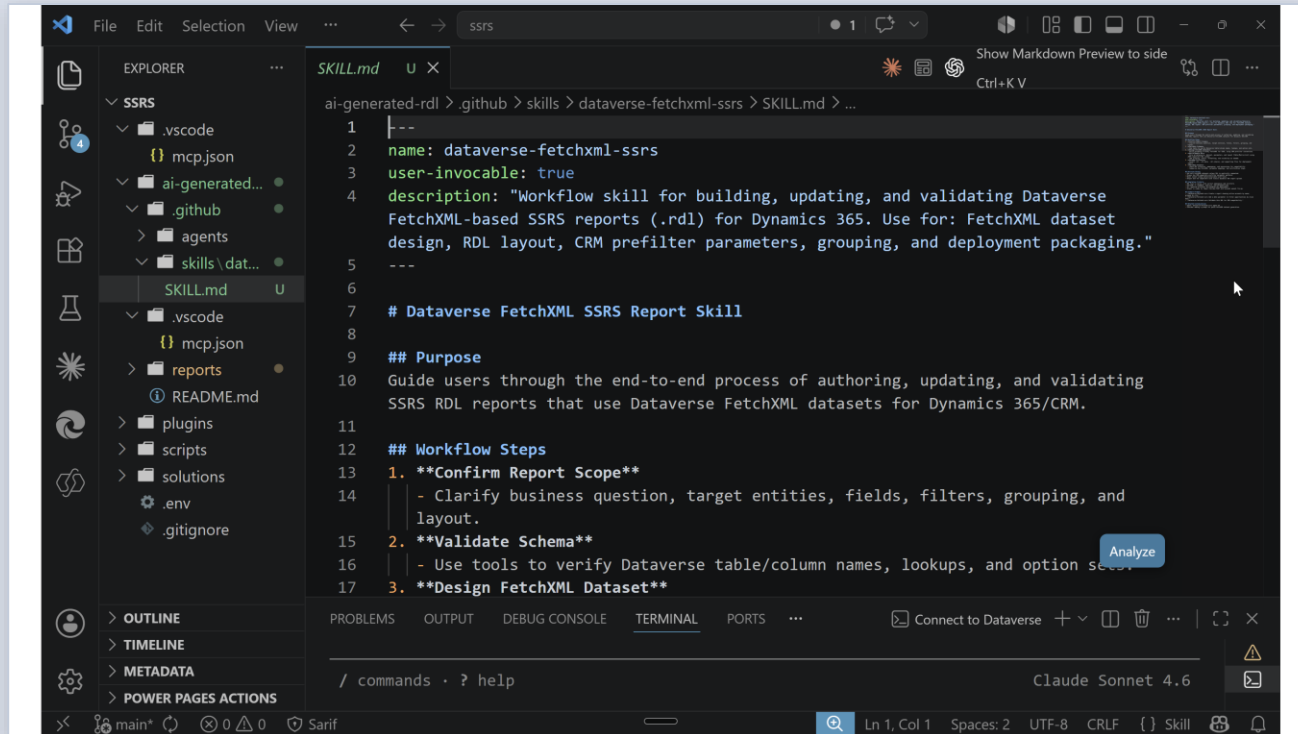
Authoring needed Visual Studio and the Report Authoring Extension. The friction won.

Power BI took the spotlight

Power BI is excellent. It is also not a printable invoice, quote, work order or statement.

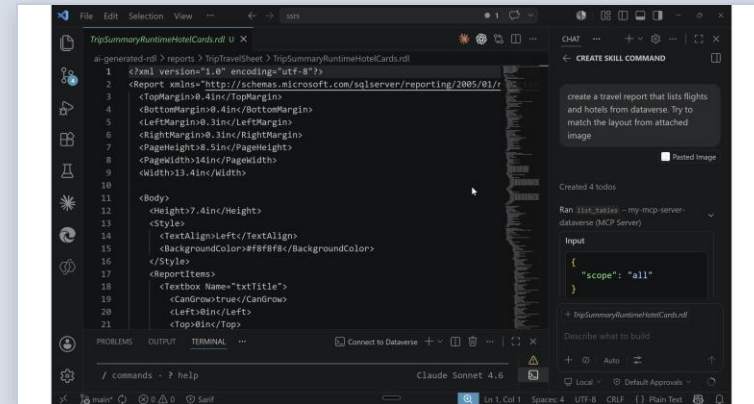
WHAT CHANGED

RDL is text, and the agent reads your schema



The screenshot shows a VS Code editor with a file explorer on the left. The file explorer shows a project structure with folders like .vscode, mcp.json, ai-generated-rdl, .github, agents, skills, and reports. The main editor displays a file named SKILL.md. The content of SKILL.md is as follows:

```
1 |--
2 |name: dataverse-fetchxml-ssrs
3 |user-invokable: true
4 |description: "Workflow skill for building, updating, and validating Dataverse
5 |FetchXML-based SSRS reports (.rdl) for Dynamics 365. Use for: FetchXML dataset
6 |design, RDL layout, CRM prefilter parameters, grouping, and deployment packaging."
7 |---
8 |
9 |# Dataverse FetchXML SSRS Report Skill
10 |
11 |## Purpose
12 |Guide users through the end-to-end process of authoring, updating, and validating
13 |SSRS RDL reports that use Dataverse FetchXML datasets for Dynamics 365/CRM.
14 |
15 |## Workflow Steps
16 |1. **Confirm Report Scope**
17 |   - Clarify business question, target entities, fields, filters, grouping, and
18 |   layout.
19 |2. **Validate Schema**
20 |   - Use tools to verify Dataverse table/column names, lookups, and option sets.
21 |3. **Design FetchXML Dataset**
```



The screenshot shows a VS Code editor with a file explorer on the left. The file explorer shows a project structure with folders like .vscode, mcp.json, ai-generated-rdl, .github, agents, skills, and reports. The main editor displays a file named TripSummaryRuntimeHotelCards.rdl. The content of the RDL file is as follows:

```
1 <?xml version="1.0" encoding="utf-8"?>
2 <Report xmlns="http://schemas.microsoft.com/sqlserver/reporting/2005/01/r
3 <TopMargin>0.2in</TopMargin>
4 <BottomMargin>0.4in</BottomMargin>
5 <LeftMargin>0.3in</LeftMargin>
6 <RightMargin>0.3in</RightMargin>
7 <PageHeight>8.5in</PageHeight>
8 <PageWidth>11in</PageWidth>
9 <Width>11.4in</Width>
10
11 <Body>
12 <Height>7.4in</Height>
13 <Style>
14 <TextAlign>Left</TextAlign>
15 <BackgroundColor>#F8F8F8</BackgroundColor>
16 </Style>
17 <ReportItems>
18 <Textbox Name="txtTitle">
19 <CanGrow>true</CanGrow>
20 <Left>0in</Left>
21 <Top>0in</Top>
```

On the right side of the editor, there is a chat window with the following content:

create a travel report that lists flights and hotels from dataverse. Try to match the layout from attached image

Created 4 todos

Ran list_skills - my-mcp-server-dataverse (MCP Server)

Input

```
{
  "scope": "all"
}
```

Describe what to build

+ Auto

+ Default Approvals

A skill for report writing

One SKILL.md covering FetchXML datasets, RDL layout and the CRM prefilter.

The agent knows the tables

describe_table over MCP, so the dataset uses real column names, not guesses.

Preview, then iterate

Open it in Report Builder, ask for a totals row, render again.

THE POINT

Twenty-year-old tech, two-year-old tooling

SSRS is one example. The pattern is the part worth taking home.

Nothing got worse

They got harder to reach. Tooling buried them, and tooling has just dug them back out.

No new licenses

Everything in this session runs on what you already pay for. The only new thing is how you get at it.

The box is back in scope

Every classic feature you wrote off as too fiddly deserves a second look this year.

Pick one thing off this list and try it in a dev environment this week. That is the whole ask.

Tak, Billund!

Open the box

Dataverse holds more than the modern designer shows you.

Email is already there

Server-side sync and the Outlook app, on the license you already hold.

MCP changed the cost

One endpoint, plus Microsoft's Dataverse Skills, and the old features are approachable again.

Print still matters

SSRS is free, it is in your environment, and Copilot will write the RDL for you.

Nick Doelman

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THANK YOU